ALVIN MUTURI KARIUKI

Backend & Full-Stack Engineer · Remote-Ready · Crisis-Tested

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend and full-stack engineer with **proven crisis-recovery capacity** across distributed async teams. Salvaged a 24-hour hackathon win after laptop failure mid-pitch and teammate no-shows. Held solo backend ownership at Ra'Asis Software after team desertion mid-sprint — reverse-engineering Django ORM bottlenecks across async, multi-timezone workflows. Currently building AI-powered products integrating multi-LLM orchestration and prompt engineering pipelines. **Blockchain-verified credentials** in entrepreneurship and innovation from Queen's University Innovation Centre.

✓ High-Performance Teams ✓ Design Thinking ✓ Customer Discovery

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend Engineering
Python · Django · Django ORM · PostgreSQL · MySQL · RESTful API Design · Redis · Celery (Message Queues) · Microservices Architecture

Frontend & Full-Stack
React.js · HTML/CSS · Bootstrap · Kotlin (Mobile) · MVVM · Jetpack Compose · Cross-Platform Integration (Vercel / Render)

AI / ML Integration
LLM Orchestration (OpenAI, Gemini, Groq, Grok, Mistral) · Prompt Engineering · HuggingFace Transformers · Sentiment Analysis (TextBlob) · AI-Assisted Development (Copilot, Windsurf, Lovable)

DevOps & Collaboration
Git / GitHub · Agile / Scrum · Async Remote Workflows (Discord, Trello, Google Meet) · Firebase · Vercel · Render · CORS Debugging

Domain Expertise
Fintech / MPESA Integration · HR-Tech (Employee Sentiment Analysis) · E-Commerce (Supply Chain Platforms)

Crisis Leadership & Remote Operations
Cold-recruiting under 1-hour deadlines · solo backend ownership after team desertion · mid-crisis stack pivots (Windsurf → Lovable) · concurrent workstream management across 6-person async teams

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Django Backend Developer — Intern

Jul 2025 – Nov 2025

Ra'Asis Software · Remote (Multi-timezone)

- **Solo Backend Ownership** Wrangled full backend responsibility after one of two backend developers deserted mid-sprint in a remote Scrum team. Coordinated asynchronously with 2 frontend developers across multiple time zones using Google Meet, Trello, and Discord, while one frontend dev simultaneously served as Scrum Master.
- **Database Performance** Identified and reverse-engineered slow Django ORM joins causing visible frontend lag during live product owner demos. Eliminated N+1 query patterns and applied `select_related` / `prefetch_related` strategies, reducing query overhead and stabilising daily scrums.
- **ORM Refactoring** Refactored monolithic Django codebase into modular, independently deployable apps, improving maintainability and reducing inter-module coupling across the pre-launch product.
- **API & Auth Delivery** Delivered scalable RESTful API architecture for pre-launch testing and implemented custom 2FA logic with a 5-minute grace period, balancing UX friction with security requirements defined by the product owner in Scrum workflow.

IT & Media Team Lead

Jan 2016 – Present

Wonders Tabernacle Church · Ruiru, Kenya

- **Zero-Downtime Operations** Operate AV matrix switchboards and manage multi-platform livestreams (TV broadcast + social media) with zero downtime tolerance during high-attendance live services, 9 years of uninterrupted delivery.
- **Real-Time Troubleshooting** Diagnose and resolve live technical failures (audio dropout, video sync drift, stream interruptions) under high-pressure, high-visibility conditions, directly transferable to on-call production incident response.

KEY PROJECTS

PulseTrack

1ST PLACE · IMPACT AFRICA NETWORK HACKATHON (25+ TEAMS)

Django · Twilio / WhatsApp API · HuggingFace Transformers · TextBlob · Chart.js

- **Crisis Recovery** Team assembled the night before via Zoom. On venue: one teammate was a no-show, cold-recruited a replacement developer abandoned by their own team. One hour before pitch, Windsurf IDE crashed mid-demo prep, directed emergency rebuild on teammate's machine using Lovable, re-architecting the demo flow in real time.
- **Product Delivered** Won 1st place among 25+ competing teams with an AI-driven HR pulse check tool: anonymous employee sentiment analysis, topic clustering, and automated burnout detection dashboards. → View Live Demo

ChamaSpark

1ST PLACE · 55-TEAM SCHOOL HACKATHON

Bootstrap · Python · Django · MPESA · PayPal · OpenAI

- **Parallel Crisis Management** Led 6-person development team while concurrently coordinating funeral transportation logistics and student leadership budget allocation for multiple team members on hackathon morning, maintaining full backend development velocity throughout.
- **Product Delivered** Delivered digital chama platform with MPESA / PayPal dual-payment integration, AI chatbot (SparkGal powered by OpenAI), and a meeting and contribution management system. Won 1st place among 55 teams.

ResumeAI

React · Django · PostgreSQL · Redis · Celery · Gemini · Groq · Grok

- **Integration Debugging** Reverse-engineered CORS misconfiguration blocking communication between React (Vercel) and Django (Render) — identified environment variable exposure and WebSocket handshake failures via log aggregation.
- **Production Deployment** Deployed AI-powered resume builder with Redis / Celery queued processing (~2 concurrent jobs). Integrated multi-LLM architecture (Gemini, Groq, Grok) for intelligent CV customisation based on job descriptions. → Live App → GitHub

PlugPoint

Kotlin · Firebase · MVVM · Jetpack Compose

- Built mobile supply chain platform eliminating trade middlemen in Kenyan local markets. Implemented Firebase Authentication, real-time chat, and MPESA payment integration connecting local suppliers directly to consumers. → GitHub

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

Emobilis Institute of Technology Jun 2025 – Aug 2025
Advanced Full Stack Web Development
- Class Representative · React.js, Django, PostgreSQL, RESTful APIs, Node.js, MongoDB, Git, Agile

Emobilis Institute of Technology Jan 2025 – May 2025
Full Stack Software Development
- **Outstanding Full Stack Engineer — 1st of 438 students** · Trophy for academic excellence
- Vice President of Student Leadership & Class Representative
- Web: HTML, CSS, Bootstrap, Python, Django, MySQL, APIs · Mobile: Kotlin, MVVM

Queen's University Innovation Centre (Remote) Jan 2026 – Mar 2026
Entrepreneurship & Innovation — Blockchain-Verified Certificates
- High-Performance Teams · Introduction to Design Thinking · Introduction to Customer Discovery

Nyeri High School 2021 – 2024
- KCSE Grade B- · A Plain in Computer Studies
- **Best Male Speaker** — National Debate Competitions · 10+ public speaking certificates

LEADERSHIP & PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

- **DevFest Nairobi 2025 Speaker:** Cold-pitched event organisers to secure a stage slot. Delivered technical presentation on AI-powered development workflows to a professional developer audience.
- **Student Leadership Vice President — Emobilis Institute:** Managed budget allocation, event coordination, and cross-team logistics while maintaining the #1 academic ranking across 438 students.
- **National Debate Champion:** Best Male Speaker across multiple national competitions. 10+ public speaking and argumentation certificates across national music festivals and debate events.